



The crispness of the display helps in making text readability easier for mails and messages, video watching a lot more fun (well, this is THE multimedia device for a lot of people) and web browsing becomes less of a strain on the eyes. While a higher resolution is regarded as a good thing for most tablets, what is more important is how crisp the display is, how easily it handles colours and a quick refresh rate to ensure that UI effects are smooth.

SYNCING CONTACTS & CALENDAR

Most Android tablets do not have dedicated desktop management software of their own, and usually expect the user to sync stuff like contacts, calendar entries and notes using the Google account. However, this isn't always the most comfortable thing to do. Like in a phone, you may usually only save contacts that have a mobile number linked to them, and not those that are just email contacts. Using Google to sync everything back to your account will mean that ALL contacts on the online account will be transferred to

your device, including just email addresses. Not only does this make the contacts list unnecessarily big, but also makes it difficult to find a contact quickly when you need to the most.

HCL gives users the option of both, thanks to the ME Connect desktop software. It is just like the desktop suites you get to manage Nokia and Blackberry smartphones, and allows you to comfortably sync contacts, calendar entries and notes from your PC. This allows the user to be selective about what stuff they want on the tablet device, and can leave out all the stuff that isn't necessary.

COMPATIBILITY WITH EXTERNAL DEVICES

Something that a few tablets offer is the USB hub feature, that allows you to plug in a USB data card into the tablet and be able to access the broadband services off it. Since some tablets are in the Wi-Fi only version, and do not have a SIM card slot for EDGE/3G connectivity on the move, their portability aspect will be considerably handicapped. The ability to plug in a USB dongle and connect that to the Internet allows for web access on the move. The likes of the Reliance 3G Tab and the Beitel Magiq don't have the USB hub feature, since they have the SIM card slots for data services. However, the ME Tab X1 from HCL and the iBall slide offer the USB hub feature.

This feature adds to the multimedia capabilities of the tablets. You can plug in USB based flash drives, and transfer multimedia and other content to the tablet. Hence, the need to connect it to a PC to transfer the data to and from the tablet is also negated.

The HDMI out on the ME Tab X1 from HCL allows HD 1080p movies and games from the tablet to be viewed on a big screen television.

PRE-LOADED APPS

Tablets and apps go hand in hand! And if the apps are preloaded on the tablet, all the better. Most tablets offer the usual suspects in the preloaded avatar - Facebook, You Tube, Twitter, a dedicated app download store in some cases and even links to download paid apps and games in trial versions. The ME Tab X1 from HCL offers real value adds in terms of the preloaded apps. Users can book discounted tickets using the Cleartrip application, books and magazines at a discount from The Wink bookstore and use the preloaded office suite for document editing and management. It also has HCL Touch, a 24x7 one-touch backup service.

BATTERY LIFE

It is critical for the tablets to offer a good battery life to stay powered up with you for a long day at work, or at least get you through a 4 hour movie viewing session. The 3500 mAh battery of the HCL ME Tab X1 aims to offer all that, and a lot more. Incidentally, the likes of the Beitel Magiq, Viewsonic ViewPad 7e and the Reliance 3G Tab offer batteries of a smaller capacity.

HCL ME TAB X1: KEY FEATURES

- Attractive price: ₹10,990
- Compatible with almost all 3G USB dongles and data cards
- Calendar, contacts, notes and tasks sync with ME Connect
- USB pen drives accessible as a plug-n-play option
- Customized apps for India with 35 content partners to offer a comprehensive user experience
- Extra from Cleartrip, Wink ebooks, emagazines worth ₹3,000 and free Hungama.com downloads with ME Tab X1
- An HDMI port for 1080p TV out
- A 3100 mAh specs battery, for around 8 hours of normal usage or 4 hours of movie watching
- Light weight of 350 grams